UU-T-1790
November 9, 1972
SUPERSEDING
MIL-T-43007C
March 13, 1968

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TOWEL, PAPER, WET-CLEANSING (PACKET)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers paper towels of one type and two sizes saturated with a cleansing solution and individually sealed in a packet (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. The towel shall be of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.2):

Size 1 - Small

Size 2 - Large

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Set-Up.
PPP-T-45	-	Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain; For Sealing and Securing.

Federal Standard:

FED-STD-123	-	Marking For Domestic Shipment (Civil agencies).

PSC 8540

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(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D.C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards, and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry Standards

T 403 - Bursting Strength of Paper.
T 410 - Weight per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, 1 Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, Georgia 30341.)

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American Society for Testing and Materials

D 1217	-	Density and Specific Gravity of Liquids by Bingham Pycnometer.
D 1331-56	-	Methods of Test for Surface and Interfacial Tension of Solutions of Surface-Active Agents.
E 70-52T	-	Determination of pH of Aqueous Solutions with the Glass Electrode (Tentative).

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, D.C. 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Paper. Towels shall be made of a white high wet strength creped paper having a basis weight of 28 ± 2 pounds (24 by 36 - 500), when tested in accordance with 4.2.1.2.

3.1.2 Cleansing solution. The cleansing solution shall consist of water, ethyl alcohol, and a synthetic detergent (see 6.4), and may be mildly scented. It may also contain a mild antiseptic and humectant. The solution shall be nontoxic and shall conform to the requirements of table I, when tested in accordance with 4.3.2.

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TABLE I. Properties of cleansing solution

Property	Minimum	Maximum
Specific gravity at 25°C.	0.970	0.990
Nonvolatile matter, percent 1/	0.75	1.75
Surface tension, dynes per cm at 25° C.	--	40.0
pH at 25° C.	5.0	9.0

1/ Nonvolatile matter shall consist primarily of nonvolatile active surfactants. Diluents other than those normally present in the surfactant shall not be present.

3.2 Finished product. Each towel, folded in accordance with commercial practice, shall be saturated with a nontoxic (see 6.3) cleansing solution as specified in 3.2.2, and heat sealed in an envelope as specified in 5.1.1.1.

3.2.1 Towel dimensions (open). The small size towel shall measure 5-1/2 ± 1/8 by 8 ± 1/8 inches and the large size towel shall measure 9-1/2 ± 1/2 by 8 ± 1/4 inches.

3.2.2 Weight of cleansing solution per towel. Each towel, after insertion in the envelope as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be saturated with cleansing solution as specified in 3.1.2. The small size towel shall have 2.8 to 4.0 grams solution and the large size towel 6.0 to 8.0 grams of solution, when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.3 Effects of accelerated aging on finished product. The finished product (see 3.2) shall show no delamination of the envelope material, no failure of the heat seals, nor a weight loss over 0.2 grams after aging. The saturated towel immediately after aging shall have a bursting strength not less than 5.0 points when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.4 Soil removal. The towel shall not shred nor pill and shall rate "good" or "excellent" in removing soil, when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.5 Labeling. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), each envelope shall be clearly and legibly printed on one side with black water-resistant ink and the following information shall remain clearly legible when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

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"TOWEL, PAPER, WET CLEANSING (PACKET)"

Stock number

Date of pack and lot number

Name of manufacturer

Address of manufacturer

The following shall also be printed: "A ready to use wet towel for cleansing the hands, face and body."

3.6 Workmanship. The finished product shall be a clean, white, properly folded, wet, even edged, paper towel saturated with cleansing solution in a clean, dry, even edged, puncture-free, sealed envelope.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Certificate of compliance. Where certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of certification.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.2.1 Inspection of materials and components. In accordance with 4.1 above, components and materials shall be inspected and tested in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase documents.

4.2.1.1 Examination of material for envelopes. Examination of material for envelopes (see 5.1.1.1) shall be made by review of a certificate of compliance (labels, invoices or other valid documents) furnished by the supplier. Nonconformance to the thickness or weight requirements shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

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4.2.1.2 Testing of paper. The basis weight of the paper shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1. The sample size shall be five sample units. A sample unit shall be ten sheets (each sheet shall be a minimum of 100 square inches); one determination per sample unit. The lot size shall consist of all the paper manufactured at one time for use in construction of the paper towel. Failure of one or more sample units shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.3.1 Examination of the end item. The end item shall be examined for the defects in the applicable subparagraphs. The lot size for purpose of determining the sample size shall be expressed in number of individual towel packets for the examination in 4.3.1.1, 4.3.1.2, and in units of shipping containers for examination in 4.3.1.3.

4.3.1.1 Examination of the end item for appearance and workmanship. The sample unit shall be one towel packet. Inspection level shall be S-4 with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 1.5 for Major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Towel:			
Appearance	Not white		X
	Not creped paper		X
Workmanship	Uneven or ragged edges		X
	Dirty, torn, breaks, slivers, shines, holes	X	
	Not properly folded		X
Envelope:			
Appearance	Not clean		X
Workmanship	Not heat sealed on all sides	X	
	Heat seal not required width	X	
	Delamination of envelope	X	
	Wet or sticky, indicating leakage of cleansing solution	X	

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Envelope: (cont'd)			
Workmanship (cont'd)	Torn or punctured	X	
	Faulty heat seal	X	
	Exterior surface of envelope not color specified		X
	Uneven or ragged edges		X
Labeling	Missing, incomplete, incorrect, or illegible		X
	Not printed with black ink		X
	Directions for use not as specified, as applicable		X

4.3.1.2 Examination of the end item for dimensional defects. The sample unit shall be one towel packet. Any dimension not within tolerances specified in 3.2.1 shall be a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.3.1.3 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements. An examination shall be made to determine whether packaging, packing, count, and markings comply with section 5. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery. Shipping containers fully prepared for delivery shall be examined for closure defects. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Packaging	
Intermediate	Paperboard box not as specified. Closures not accomplished by specified methods or materials.
Packing	Broken, bulged, torn, distorted shipping container; not specified type.

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Examine	Defect
Count	Number of intermediate packages per shipping container is less than required. Number of unit packages per intermediate package less than required. 1/
Marking	Missing, incorrect, incomplete or illegible, improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.

1/ For this defect, one intermediate box from each shipping container in the sample shall be examined.

4.3.2 Testing of the end items. The end item shall be tested for the characteristics specified in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in packets of the same size. The sample unit for testing shall be twenty packets, except for preparing the composite sample. The sample size shall be five. Each sample unit shall be selected from a different shipping container in the lot. For the composite sample a sufficient number of packets selected shall be taken in order to obtain the 150 ml. of solution, as required in accordance with 4.4.2. All test reports shall contain the individual values utilized in expressing the final result. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any test requirement specified.

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INSTRUCTIONS FOR TESTING OF THE END ITEM — TABLE II

CHARACTERISTIC	Specification Reference		Requirements Applicable To		Number Determinations Per Unit Sample	Results Reported As		Inspect Level	AQL
	Requirement	Test Method	Individual Unit	Inspection Lot or Batch Composite		Pass or Fail	Numerically to Nearest		
Cleansing solution:									
Specific gravity	Table I	4.4.3		X	Average of 2		0.001		
Nonvolatile matter	Table I	4.4.4		X	Average of 2		0.1 percent		
Surface tension (dynes per cm)	Table I	4.4.5		X	Average of 2		dyne		
Acidity (pH) value	Table I	4.4.6		X	1		0.1 pH value		
Weight of cleansing solution per towel	3.2.2	4.4.7	X		Average of 3		0.1 g		
Effects of accelerated aging:									
Delamination (envelope)	3.3	4.4.8	X		1	X			
Failure of heat seals	3.3	4.4.8	X		1	X			
Average weight loss (cleansing solution)	3.3	4.4.8	X		Average of 10		0.1 g		
Bursting strength	3.3	4.4.8	X		Average of 2		nearest 0.1 point		
Soil removal	3.4	4.4.9	X		1	X			
Water resistance of ink	3.5	4.4.10	X		1	X			
Leakage	5.1.1.1	4.4.11	X		1	X			

AMXRE Form 598
8 February 1965

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4.4 Test procedures.

4.4.1 Basis weight of creped paper. Determine basis weight of the creped paper by using TAPPI Method T 410.

4.4.2 Cleansing solution. Cut off the sealed edge carefully of one side of a packet, but not the paper towel. Hold the open side down over a funnel inserted into a 10 ml graduated cylinder (with glass stopper) and squeeze packet with hands. Collect the solution, remove the funnel, and immediately stopper the graduated cylinder to prevent loss of volatile materials. Collect 100 ml of solution by repeating the above procedure and store in a glass stoppered bottle.

4.4.3 Specific gravity. Determine the specific gravity at 25° C. of this extracted cleansing solution using ASTM Method D 1217.

4.4.4 Nonvolatile matter. Place 5 to 10 ml of the extracted cleansing solution into a tared weighing bottle and weigh to the nearest 0.0001 gram. Dry to constant weight in a forced convection oven maintained at 105° ± 2° C. Determine percent nonvolatile matter. The supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance that nonvolatile matter consists primarily of nonvolatile active surfactants and that diluents other than those normally present in the surfactants are not present.

4.4.4.1 Calculation.

$$\text{Percent nonvolatile matter} = \frac{\text{Weight of residue}}{\text{Weight of solution}} \times 100$$

4.4.5 Surface tension at 25° C. Pipette 10 ml of the extracted solution into a 250 ml volumetric flask. Dilute to 250 ml with cool, boiled, distilled water. Adjust temperature to 25° C. Determine surface tension of the dilute solution in accordance with ASTM D 1331.

4.4.6 pH value. Transfer 10 ml of the extracted solution to a 50 ml volumetric flask and dilute to 50 ml with cool, boiled, distilled water. Adjust temperature to 25° C. Determine pH of the diluted solution in accordance with ASTM E 70T.

4.4.7 Weight of cleansing solution per towel. Record the average weight of 3 unopened packets weighed to the nearest 0.1 gram. Slit open one side of each packet, remove towel, unfold and identify each towel and envelope. Dry envelopes and towels for 2 hours in a forced convection oven maintained at 105° ± 2° C. Replace each towel in its original envelope, cool in a desiccator and reweigh to the nearest 0.1 gram. Determine the weight loss for each packet and record the average of the 3 losses as the weight of the cleansing solution per towel.

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4.4.8 Effect of accelerated aging. Weigh ten towel packets to the nearest 0.010 gram and place them in a circulating forced-draft oven. Maintain at 60° ± 2° C. temperature for 48 hours. Let the towel packets cool in a desiccator and reweigh; record the average weight loss as the weight loss caused by accelerated aging. Inspect sample envelopes for delamination of envelope material and failure of heat sealed edges. Remove wet towel from envelopes and determine bursting strength of the wet towel by using TAPPI Method T 403.

4.4.9 Performance.

4.4.9.1 Soiling mixture. Mix 36.0 grams of charcoal, airfloat grade (see 6.5), and 64.0 grams of mineral oil U.S.P. to form a smooth uniform paste.

4.4.9.2 Hand cleaning procedure. Apply approximately 0.1 grams of soiling mixture to the palm of one hand. With one finger of the other hand, uniformly rub the soiling mixture into the skin for one minute; keep the soiled area confined to the palm of the hand. Wipe the soiled palm of the hand with both sides of the test towel (one 9-1/2 by 8 inch towel or two 5-1/2 by 8 inch towels) not longer than two minutes. Note the time required to remove the soil from the palm of the hand. Observe palm of hand for cleanliness especially in the creases of the skin and examine the towel for shreading or pilling. Wipe palm of hand vigorously with a clean, dry, white paper towel (see 6.6), and observe amount of soil rubbed off on the dry white paper towel.

4.4.9.3 Performance rating. Rate the towel as follows:

Excellent - Soil completely removed from palm of hand in 1-1/2 minutes or less. No more than a trace of soil barely shows on dry wiping towel.

Good - Soil completely removed from palm of hand in 1-1/2 minutes except for slight amount of soil in the creases of the skin. No more than a slight amount of soil shows on dry wiping towel.

Fair - Soil almost completely removed from palm or hand in two minutes except for soil in creases of the skin. A very definite amount of soil shows on dry wiping towel.

Poor - A gross amount of soil remains on the palm of hand. A substantial amount of soil shows on dry wiping towel.

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4.4.10 Water resistance of ink. Immerse one envelope in water at 26.6° C. for one hour. Note if ink smears or remains clearly legible.

4.4.11 Leakage test. The filled and sealed envelope shall be tested for leakage by submerging in water contained in a desiccator or other suitable container, and maintaining a vacuum of 25 inches of mercury (atmospheric pressure 29.9 inches) for at least 30 seconds. A leak is indicated by a stream of bubbles. Isolated bubbles caused by entrapped air are not considered as signs of leakage.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging. Each towel, folded and saturated with cleansing solution as specified in 3.2, shall be unit packaged in a close-fitting water-vaporproof envelope. The envelope shall be made of a 3-ply laminated barrier material consisting of 0.001 inch thick polyethylene film, 0.00035-inch thick dead soft aluminum foil, and 25-pound (± 5.0 percent) basis weight (24 by 36-500) super calendered pouch paper (components listed from inside out, respectively). The polyethylene film shall be laminated to the aluminum foil by means of an extrusion coating or by bonding. The bonding agent shall be flexible and shall not be affected by the cleansing solution in the towel. The pouch paper shall be bonded to the aluminum foil with polyethylene applied at the rate of approximately 7-1/2 pounds per ream or with a water-resistant flexible adhesive applied at the rate of approximately 3-pounds per ream. The exterior color of the finished envelope shall be white, dull yellow or a light brown as specified (see 6.2). The envelope shall be formed by heat sealing along the edges on all four sides. Each envelope made from two pieces of barrier material shall have all heat seals a minimum of 1/8-inch in width. Each envelope made from one piece of barrier material folded upon itself shall have all heat seals a minimum of 1/8-inch width, except the heat seal applied to the folded side shall be a minimum of 1/16-inch width. The filled and sealed envelope shall not show leakage when tested in accordance with 4.4.11.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. One hundred towels of one size only, unit packaged as specified in 5.1.1.1, shall be packaged in a snug-fitting folding paperboard box conforming to variety 1, style III or VIII, type G,

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class 1 of PPP-B-566; or setup paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style optional of PPP-B-676. Box closure shall be secured with 2-inch minimum width gummed paper tape conforming to type III, grade A of PPP-T-45, applied at the center of the length opening and along the bottom and up each side at least one-half the depth of the box.

5.1.2 Level B (Civil agencies). One hundred towel packets of one size only, shall be packed in a snug-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676.

5.1.3 Level C. Each towel shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Two thousand large size towels, or four thousand small size towels, packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed, and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Two thousand large size towels, or four thousand small size towels, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, type CF (variety SW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II as specified in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with the appendix of the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Towels, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classification Rules or National Motor Freight Classification Rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

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5.3.2 Military requirements. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, intermediate packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The wet cleansing paper towel covered by this specification is intended for use in removing ordinary or fairly difficult soils from hands, face, and body without using soap, water, or another towel.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Size of towel required (see 1.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(d) Selection of exterior color of the finished envelope (see 5.1.1.1).
(e) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
(f) When level B packaging is required for civil agencies (see 5.1.2).

6.3 Toxicity. Any questions regarding toxicity should be referred by the procuring agency to the Departmental Medical Authority. For Army procurements, the Surgeon General will act as advisor to the procuring agency.

6.4 Synthetic nonionic detergent. A ten mole ethylene oxide adduct to a hydrophobe such as octyl or nonyl phenol has been found to be satisfactory as the detergent in the item.

6.5 Charcoal. Charcoal (airfloat grade) may be obtained from New England Charcoal Company, 70 Vernon Street, Somerville, Massachusetts 02143.

6.6 Paper towels. Paper towels (type 900-L or equal) for performance test specified in 4.4.9 may be obtained from Kimberly-Clark Corporation, Neenah, Wisconsin 54956.

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Review activities:

Army - MD
DSA - DP

User activities:

Navy - MC, MS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Interest:

GSA-FSS
VA-DMS
NASA-JFK

Project No. 8540-0025

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